PAYPAL AI HACKATHON · AGENTIC COMMERCE

Mandate

Spending guardrails for AI shopping agents, settled with PayPal.

github.com/lgf2111/mandate

THE GAP

Agents can shop.
They can also spend.
Nothing in between.

Today the choice is to hand over the card, or not use the agent.

A MANDATE

Rules in a database, not a sentence in a prompt.

- The agent can read these rules.
- It cannot rewrite them.
- They are checked in code at checkout.
- A human approves, not the model.

MANDATE · WEEKEND RUNNING GEAR	
Budget	$200.00
Per transaction	$150.00
Approval above	$100.00
Allowed merchants	RunCo, TrailSupply
Blocked merchants	SketchySports
Categories	running, apparel
Expires	in 7 days

THE FLOW

The model proposes. The code decides.



allow · require approval · deny · with written reasons

Only an allowed cart reaches PayPal. Denials never create an order.

`evaluate()` runs again at checkout — a decision cannot be stale or forged.

LIVE EXAMPLE

Trail shoes, plus socks: $115.00

PROPOSAL

Trail Runner 2 · RunCo	$94.00
Merino Sock 3-pack · RunCo	$21.00
Total	**$115.00**

APPROVAL REQUIRED

Above the $100.00 auto-approve threshold

Budget remaining after: $85.00

Approve and pay

```
captured · DEMO-CAP-11985ed7 · budget now $115.00 of $200.00
```

SAME CART, ASK AGAIN

Denied — because the numbers moved.

PROPOSAL

Trail Runner 2 · RunCo	$94.00
Merino Sock 3-pack · RunCo	$21.00
Total	**$115.00**

DENY

$115.00 exceeds the
$85.00 remaining

`no_payment_is_possible`

`Same model. Same request. Different outcome, because the budget is state.`

TRUST BOUNDARY

One function decides. Nothing else does.

AGENT · UNTRUSTED

Proposes SKUs from a fixed catalog

Writes its own rationale

Can be wrong, or manipulated

Never sees a payment credential

EVALUATE() · TRUSTED

Pure: no clock, no network, no randomness

16 unit tests, cent-exact boundaries

Re-runs at checkout, reads spend from the store

Returns written reasons, not a boolean

The model proposes. The code disposes.

PROOF

It runs, and it is checked.

48
`tests`
policy, API, agent, PayPal

9/9
`smoke checks`
against a running server

1
`container`
builds, runs, serves

CI
`green`
typecheck · test · build

No credentials? The whole demo runs in demo mode — and says so on every ledger row.

`npm run dev → propose → evaluate → approve → PayPal capture → ledger`

Known limits, written down: no auth, unsigned webhooks, no atomic budget reservation.

MANDATE

The model proposes.
The code disposes.

github.com/lgf2111/mandate · MIT · runs in 30 seconds, no credentials

PayPal AI Hackathon 2026 · Agentic Commerce